How can editorial structure

shape the way stories are experienced

rather than simply presented?

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Method Archive Contact

Editorial publication exam Project Dear Magazine Year 2024-2025

Dear,

Issue 00
Queen Migration

What do you do when you can't cut "out"

Dear,

Dear,

Dear Magazine

Concept Development Narrative Structure Visual Direction & Style Interaction Prototyping Interaction Design

Context

Editorial design is often understood as the arrangement of existing content. Dear Magazine approaches it differently: publication structure is inflated as an active narrative medium.

The structure of the publication therefore influences not only what is seen, but how attention moves and how emotion accumulates over time.

The reader does not encounter every story at once.

Meaning develops through sequence, pause, contrast, repetition, and emphasis.

The research connects editorial systems with storytelling, behaviour, visual rhythm, narrative sequencing, and emotional pacing.

How can editorial structure shape the way stories are experienced rather than simply presented?

Its purpose was to ground the concept. It was to understand how editorial decisions guide interpretation, where the reader slows down, what becomes prominent, which relationships appear between stories, and how space can create anticipation or reflection.

Concept Development

The project gradually shifted from page design to narrative choreography.

Individual spreads could not be judged in isolation. Each page needed to prepare for what followed and retain a relationship with what came before. Typography, spacing, sequencing, and pacing became tools for constructing a reading experience rather than laying out a collection of articles.

The publication emerged as a system of transitions —between image and text, density and silence, information and atmosphere.

Process

Research editorial structures and reading behaviours.

1. Organise content around narrative relationships

2. Develop a typography system that guides attention.

3. Develop a typography system that guides attention.

4. Translate the editorial logic into a complete publication.

Dear Magazine uses publication design as a system for directing attention and shaping meaning.

Within That System:

- Typography Establishes Hierarchy;
- Layout Controls Rhythm;
- Sequencing Creates Emotional Progression;
- Spacing Introduces Silence And Emphasis;
- Editorial Structure Connects Individual Stories Into A Larger Experience.

The design does not sit around the content. It determines how the content if encountered.

Outcome

The project results in an editorial publication, a typography system, narrative layouts, a publication design system, and a visual story-telling framework.

Together, these elements create continuity across individual pages while allowing each story its own tone. The publication functions as one reading experience rather than a series of disconnected compositions.

Reflection

Dear Magazine reinforced my understanding that communication depends on rhythm as much as information.

Meaning emerges through how people move through content, not only through the content itself. Editorial design became a way of working with time: deciding when to reveal, when to connect, and when to leave space for the reader.

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